Official 2026 Policies

General Policies

Notice:

Genshiken Festival's (the festival) organising team reserves the right to amend the policies listed below at any time. The team also reserves the right to enforce and interpret the policies listed in this document. Failure to abide by these policies may result in a warning or confiscation of convention admission as well as ejection from the event.

Admission:

Your Genshiken Festival badge is the property of the convention and must be returned if admission is revoked. To claim a lost badge, you must present a government-issued ID with a matching name. Lost passes incur a replacement fee, and attendees should visit the staff table for assistance.

Genshiken Festival reserves the right to decline pass replacements and to refuse or revoke admission to the convention at any time and for any reason. Children under 13 must be accompanied by a parent or guardian, with parents and guardians being held responsible for their behaviour.

By accepting their badge, the wearer agrees to adhere to all convention policies set forth by the Genshiken Festival.

Registration:

Ticket purchases will occur online on Zeffy linked on the website. Early bird tickets will be available until March 1st, 2026.

Please note that the Genshiken Festival reserves the right to cease badge sales and registration at any time.

Convention Hours:
Saturday, March 28th 2026 from 11:00 AM to 7:00 PM

All attendees must prominently display their badge at all times as proof of entitlement to access Genshiken Festival function spaces and events.

Final Sale Policy:

Genshiken will have a no-refund policy for general attendees, if a badge is purchased in advance and the attendee cannot attend then this does not constitute grounds for a refund. Genshiken Festival entry passes are non-transferrable and sharing a badge is

not permitted. By purchasing an entry badge I agree to the other policies outlined on the event website.

All purchases made in the event space will count as a final sale and refunds or exchanges will not be offered for any reason.

COVID-19 Policy:

The Genshiken Festival will adhere to the guidelines set by the Ontario provincial government. While we won't be verifying the vaccine status of attendees, masks are permitted and are recommended for those who may be immunocompromised or otherwise vulnerable.

Public Safety:

Behaviour such as violence, stalking, harassment, hate speech, or any other disruptive conduct will not be tolerated at the convention. Offenders will be promptly removed from the premises, and if necessary, law enforcement and campus security will be involved.

Prohibited Actions include:

- Cutting in lines, pushing, engaging in horseplay, or displaying rudeness towards convention staff.
- Bringing weapons, drugs, fireworks, or flammable liquids onto the premises.
- The consumption of alcohol. The legal drinking age in Ontario is 19.
- Possessing water guns, laser pointers, metal props, or any other items deemed unsafe without the prior approval from the Genshiken Festival.
- Participating in glomping, using excessively noisy props, or engaging in activities that may startle or cause harm to others.
- Riding hoverboards or other powered wheeled devices, excluding medical assistive devices.
- The operation of drones.

Accessibility:

The Genshiken Festival is committed to ensuring equal access for festival attendees with disabilities, whether they are physical, mental, sensory, or otherwise, whether permanent or temporary.

The Genshiken Festival also supports attendees' freedom to use names, pronouns, and restrooms that align with their gender presentation

Here are ways for everyone to assist those with disabilities:

- Refrain from using wheelchair-accessible restrooms especially for changing into cosplay.
- Be mindful of using heavily scented personal products to accommodate attendees with sensitivities.
- Prioritise allowing those using wheelchairs or other mobility devices to access elevators first.

Animals:

Service animals are permitted everywhere within the festival spaces, as mandated by Ontario law.

Pets, including dogs, cats, birds, small animals, and exotic animals, are not permitted inside the festival spaces during any events without prior permission from the venue.

If you choose to bring a companion animal to the convention, it is your responsibility to ensure the animal is properly cared for, not in distress and under your direct control at all times in the public areas of residence or leave the festival.

The Event Security Team reserves the right to remove an unattended pet from the event at any time.

Code of Conduct:

Genshiken Festival reserves the right, in its sole discretion, to refuse admission, expel from the premises, and/or seize or cancel or revoke the ticket without refund, any person who violates these Terms and Conditions or whose conduct is deemed objectionable, in Genshiken Festival's sole discretion.

At the Genshiken Festival, it's essential for everyone to feel comfortable and safe. Clear communication is paramount: "No" means no, and "Go away" means exactly that - leave immediately and do not return.

Intentionally touching anyone without their consent is considered assault. Activities like "glomping" and offering "free hugs" still require prior permission.

Sexual Harrassment and Sexual Assault are legal matters that fall outside the jurisdiction of the Genshiken Festival, and thus will be referred to the appropriate authorities for investigation and action. However, instances involving overtly sexual language or behaviour, or physical touching of a personal nature (such as areas of the body typically covered by underwear), will be taken extremely seriously.

Respect people's privacy and bodily autonomy; refrain from touching individuals who appear to be transgender or crossplaying without their consent.

Items such as Yaoi paddles, Yuri paddles, and similar objects are not permitted in public areas. Similar items with similar purposes are strictly prohibited from being carried in the festival spaces. Utilising a Yaoi or Yuri paddle in public areas will result in immediate loss of convention badge without refund, removal from the festival space, and may potentially involve police intervention.

Pressuring or coercing individuals into public displays of affection (PDAs), regardless of gender or sexual orientation, constitutes harassment.

Simple public display of affections (PDAs), such as holding hands, brief hugs, or innocent kisses, are acceptable. However, anything more intimate should be reserved for private spaces, like your home, to ensure bystanders are not made uncomfortable.

Same-sex couples have the same rights to express as male-female couples without attracting undue attention, whether positive or negative.

Pressuring or bribing individuals to engage in PDAs in public spaces, regardless of sexual orientation, constitutes harassment and will not be tolerated.

Avoid making assumptions about a cosplayer's love life based on their costume or interactions with friends. If uncertain, it is advisable to politely inquire about their age before engaging in any actions that may lead to regrettable consequences.

Harassment includes, but is not limited to, unwanted talking, touching, or photographing, as well as lingering around someone who asked you to leave, or engaging in behaviour meant to disrupt someone's festival experience.

Anyone who feels threatened or harassed, or witnesses such behaviour, should seek assistance from festival staff/volunteers immediately.

Festival Space:

The following rules apply to all Genshiken Festival spaces:

- Seating is available on a first-come, first-served basis.
- Recording is permitted, as long as consent is given.
- Recording in panel, workshop, or special event stages are permitted. For the Maid Cafe and the Artist/Vendor Alley, please do ask consent if you plan on recording or taking photographs.
- Flash photography is not allowed during stage performances.

- Pets are not permitted inside Festival spaces without prior authorization; however, service animals are welcome as mandated by Ontario law.
- Posting signs or flyers in unauthorised locations may result in responsibility for clean-up costs imposed by the venue.
- Helium-filled balloons are not permitted inside the event space.

Violation of rules or engaging in any illegal or disruptive behaviour will lead to the loss of convention membership and potential legal action by the Genshiken Festival or The Warehouse.

Alcohol and Substance Policy:

There will strictly be no consumption of alcohol, substances, drugs, or otherwise on event grounds, and any attendees deemed to be under the influence of alcohol or such substances by event staff will be denied entry, and be asked to leave the premises. Smoking (tobacco or cannabis) and vaping (with or without nicotine) is not allowed within event premises. Repeated violations of this policy may result in being banned from future events, and the proper authorities being contacted.

Vendors/Artists:

Only vendors/artists with contracts approved by the Genshiken Festival are permitted to conduct sales within convention spaces, including the Artist/Vendor Alley.

Sales in parking lots or outside on The Warehouse are strictly prohibited.

Items banned for sale, such as swords, knives, metal props, or yaoi/yuri paddles are banned for safety reasons. Any vendor/artist that is seen selling these will result in loss of convention badge without refund, and removal from convention space.

Panhandling is prohibited by local bylaws and will not be tolerated within convention spaces.

Genshiken Festival does not assume responsibility for mediating disputes between vendors and dissatisfied customers. **It is advisable to always request a receipt for purchases.**

Photography:

By participating in the Genshiken Festival, please note that you and any associated names or logos of your company, group, or organisation (such as team or club) may be captured in photographs or video taken by media personnel, Genshiken Festival

staff/volunteers, or industry representatives. These photographs may be utilised for marketing or promotional purposes.

Any photographers seeking to capture posed or candid pictures of individual attendees must obtain permission beforehand.

Only photographers who have purchased space in Photo Alley may charge for taking photographs in convention space.

Photographers are not permitted to set up lights, backdrops, or any other equipment in convention spaces without prior authorization.

Photography is prohibited in the Artist/Vendor Alley unless given consent and prior authorization, as well as anywhere it obstructs traffic flow or poses a safety hazard by creating crowding.

Cosplay Guidelines:

Costumes worn at the Genshiken Festival must adhere to the following guidelines, failure to do so may result in a request to cover up or leave the festival:

- All festival attendees, whether in costume or regular attire, must ensure that opaque fabric covers the areas of the body that would typically be covered by jockey shorts or bra and panties.
- Nudity is strictly prohibited, and opaque bodysuits that closely resemble nudity are not permitted if they are overly accurate.
- Costume components that may be deemed disturbing or offensive to others are not permitted.
- Fetish costume elements such as chains or handcuffs, which may pose a safety hazard to the wearer or others, must be removed.
- Footwear with soles must be worn within festival spaces; however, “invisible” shoes are acceptable for cosplay purposes.
- Individuals wearing bulky costumes, those that restrict vision or movement, or present other safety concerns should be accompanied by an escort in high-traffic areas. In the absence of an escort, you may be asked to remove and safely carry the problematic portions of your costumes.

It is the expectation of all attendees, boothers, as well as festival staff and volunteers to use discretion on discerning appropriate cosplay. Genshiken Festival reserves the right to ask attendees to change/leave if their cosplay is deemed inappropriate or offensive.

Weapons and Large Props:

All weapons or large props must undergo inspection and approval by the Genshiken Festival staff.

Live firearms, weapons prohibited by Canadian law, replicas of contemporary firearms, projectile weapons, props made of metal, and yaoi/yuri paddles are strictly prohibited at Genshiken Festival.

All weapons must be properly holstered, sheathed, or slung, except when posing for photographs. Additionally, all props must be carried safely and remain under your control at all times.

Engaging in horseplay, careless or unsafe handling of props, drawing of weapons, or using props to threaten individuals or disrupt the peace of the festival will not be tolerated.

For the safety of all festival attendees, the following policy regarding weapons and prohibited items will be strictly enforced. It is imperative that all cosplayers read and fully comply with these regulations. Failure to do so may result in warnings and potential loss of convention admission.

- Absolutely no live firearms are permitted. Removing the firing pin or bolt does not exempt firearms from this rule.
- Prohibited weapons, as defined by applicable Canadian laws, are strictly forbidden. Examples include, but are not limited to:
    - Butterfly Knives (Bali-Song) or Switchblade/Drop Blade style knives.
    - Nunchucks, Tonfas, Shurikens, or other similarly restricted martial arts weapons, which are illegal under the Criminal Code of Canada (foam models of these items are permitted).
    - Law enforcement items such as batons, tasers, or mace.
- Replicas of contemporary firearms, beginning from the era of revolvers (U.S Civil War forward) to any currently manufactured firearms, are not allowed.
- Metal weapons, including swords, knives, and daggers, as well as yaoi/yuri paddles, are prohibited. However, plastic or wooden replicas that resemble metal are permitted.
- All weapons must be holstered, sheathed, or slung in an approved fashion.
- Weapons should not be drawn or displayed outside of convention function spaces.
- Consideration must be given to the physical safety and peace of mind of all individuals, including the general public and venue staff, at all times.
- All weapons or large props must be inspected and authorised by the Genshiken Festival staff at the Registration table.

- Any weapon that fails to meet the safety criteria set by the Genshiken Festival staff must be immediately returned to storage (e.g. your vehicle or bag) for the duration of the convention or checked by the staff. It is your responsibility to retrieve your checked weapons. If any props or weapons left with staff beyond the close of registration, please contact one of the organisers on the discord or email admin@genshikenfestival.ca
- Public safety and festival staff/ volunteers reserve the right to inspect weapons, peace bonds, and convention passes at any time. Signs of tampering will be referred to the Organizing Team for confirmation.
- Horseplay involving weapons, regardless of whether participants are consenting parties, will not be tolerated. All individuals involved may be penalised based on the severity of the offence. Any complaints regarding this behaviour will be addressed immediately by the Genshiken Festival.

Public Safety and festival staff have the right to inspect any prop or weapon on request and take action where necessary.

Failure to adhere to one or more of the above rules may result in one or all of the following penalties:

- Immediate loss of the privilege to carry weapons
- Expulsion, without refund, from the Genshiken Festival

Acts of gross negligence or public endangerment may result in criminal charges beyond the control of the Genshiken Festival, as the general public may not be aware of the festival and may react drastically if they feel threatened.

Privacy Policy:

The Genshiken Festival is committed to safeguarding the privacy of personal information belonging to our Attendees, Organizers, Sponsors, Volunteers, and Employees, which includes contract employees and customers. It is essential for maintaining consumer trust and goodwill that Genshiken Festival collects, uses, and discloses personal information with care and subject to consent.

Personal Information Policy:

Genshiken Festival collects, uses, and discloses personal information only for purposes that a reasonable person would consider appropriate to Genshiken Festival activities.

Personal information, defined as any data that can distinguish, identify, or contact a specific individual, will be held in strict confidence and utilised solely for the purposes for which it was collected.

Stringent measures will be implemented to safeguard personal information, meaning only volunteers and the organising team will have access to this information in a restricted access system.

Accountability:

All organising team members and volunteers are tasked with making sure rules are followed on a daily basis, ensuring adherence to guidelines, protocols, and standards consistently throughout the course of their duties.

Genshiken Festival values transparency and encourages the reporting of privacy concerns through accessible and confidential channels. Individuals are encouraged to raise any issues, violations, or incidents related to privacy directly to designated personnel or through established reporting mechanisms.

Identifying Purposes:

Unless the purpose is evident due to the nature of the transaction, Genshiken Festival representatives will clarify the purpose for which personal information is collected at or before the time of collection. Primary purposes relate to meeting Genshiken Festival's obligations under its activities and undertakings.

Consent

Consent may be expressed or implied and can be given in various forms, including in writing, electronically, orally, or through conduct. Withdrawal of consent is possible at any time, provided in writing, electronically or orally.

Limiting Collection:

Genshiken Festival's collection of information will be confined to what is necessary for the identified purposes.

Limiting Use, Disclosure, and Retention:

Personal information will not be used or disclosed for purposes beyond those for which it was collected, except with specific consent or as required by law. Information will be retained only as long as necessary for these purposes or as mandated by law.

Accuracy:

Personal information will be maintained as accurate, complete, and up-to-date as required for its intended use.

Safeguards:

Genshiken Festival will protect personal information through security measures of a restricted access system only accessible to the organising team and the volunteers.

Openness:

Information regarding our policies and practices concerning the management of personal information will be readily available to individuals.

Convention Attendance Privacy:

By attending the Genshiken Festival, individuals acknowledge that their names or logos of associated companies, groups, or organisations may appear in photographs taken by Media, Genshiken Festival Staff/Volunteers, or Industry personnel for marketing or promotional purposes.